Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Monday, 19 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Light rain	Light drizzle	Overcast
14° 10°	13° 8°	14° 9°	11° 3°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Health Secretary says ending 'corridor care' in hospitals for children is a top priority, especially with winter approaching.**

Yvette Cooper has announced a significant £140 million investment into England's urgent care system. This aims to tackle the issue of children being treated in hospital corridors due to a lack of beds.

HEALTH · UK

2 **Police are hunting for two suspects after an officer was injured in a shooting incident.**

Detectives say a firearm has been recovered from the scene. A man and a woman reportedly fled after the officer was hurt.

CRIME · UK

3 **The Health Secretary has called NHS data breaches a 'disgrace' after staff were sacked for accessing patient records.**

Fifteen NHS employees were dismissed for improperly accessing the records of victims from the Nottingham attacks. This highlights serious concerns about patient confidentiality.

HEALTH · UK

4 **A 14-year-old boy has been stabbed in an attack at a shopping centre in Greater Manchester.**

Police say the boy's injuries are not thought to be life-threatening or life-changing. Investigations are ongoing into the incident.

CRIME · UK

5 **The Green Party leader, Carla Polanski, has confirmed that a controversial motion stating 'Zionism is racism' will stand until 2028.**

While Polanski expressed a desire to amend the motion, she stated it would remain in place for the foreseeable future. This follows significant debate within the party.

POLITICS · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Turkish girl group Manifest are set for their first UK concert at Wembley Arena, after a whirlwind year.**

The group has gone from reality TV to a global audience in just twelve months. They're excited to bring their music to British fans.

ON AIR — Have you heard of Manifest? What's your favourite up-and-coming band?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

2 **Dame Judi Dench has joined the campaign to keep The Archers in Birmingham, describing potential moves as 'similar to Corrie leaving the North-West'.**

The cast of the long-running radio drama are concerned about plans to move production away from its traditional home. Dame Judi is lending her support to their efforts.

ON AIR — The Archers has been in Birmingham for decades – do you think it should stay there?

RADIO · ONGOING

3 **Marvel fans can look forward to a new Welsh superhero, complete with a Cardiff accent, in the upcoming Disney+ series VisionQuest.**

Lauren Morais will play the villain Lisa Molinari, bringing a distinctly Welsh flavour to the Marvel universe. It's exciting to see more regional accents in big productions.

ON AIR — Which regional accent would you love to hear on a superhero next?

TV · UPCOMING

4 **The soundtrack to the hit show The Traitors is being praised for making 'murder fun' and setting the perfect tone.**

It's not just the treachery and villainy that makes the show so compelling. The music helps create that unique, campy atmosphere viewers love.

ON AIR — What's your favourite TV show soundtrack that really sets the mood?

TV · ONGOING

5 **Welsh singer Jamie Miller says his Off Campus star collaboration 'gave me chills' as his viral hit narrowly missed the UK number one spot.**

He's hoping he's 'doing Wales proud' with his success. It's fantastic to see Welsh talent making waves on the international music scene.

ON AIR — Have you been listening to Jamie Miller's music? Which new artists are you loving right now?

MUSIC · ONGOING

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City are six points clear at the top of the Premier League after a 3-2 win over Ipswich.**

Erling Haaland scored twice as Enzo Maresca's side secured their seventh straight league victory. They're looking unstoppable at the moment.

ON AIR — Can anyone stop Manchester City this season, or are they destined for another title?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Liverpool came from behind to beat nine-man Brentford 2-1 in a dramatic Premier League clash.**

Brentford had two players sent off, Yehor Yarmoliuk and Vitaly Janelt, as Liverpool capitalised on their numerical advantage. It was a hard-fought victory for the Reds.

ON AIR — What did you make of the referee's decisions in the Liverpool game?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Daniel Dubois cemented his status as Britain's leading heavyweight with a devastating second-round stoppage of Fabio Wardley.**

Dubois retained his WBO title in London with a dominant performance. The boxing world is now buzzing about what's next for the champion.

ON AIR — Who do you think Daniel Dubois should fight next?

BOXING · UK

4 **England's Rugby League World Cup campaign has been thrown into jeopardy after a stunning defeat to Tonga in their opening match.**

Tonga pulled off a major upset, beating England at HBF Park. It's a wake-up call for the host nation early in the tournament.

ON AIR — Were you surprised by England's Rugby League World Cup defeat?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5 **Toulouse denied Exeter Chiefs a famous Champions Cup victory in France, fighting back to win a frenetic contest.**

Exeter had been in a strong position, but Toulouse, despite having 14 men for much of the game, secured the win. It was a thrilling encounter for rugby fans.

ON AIR — What a game! Do you think Exeter will bounce back in the Champions Cup?

RUGBY UNION · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A new study suggests that the sound of distant church bells is particularly soothing for city dwellers.**
   Researchers found that the gentle pealing, even when faint, helps to create a sense of calm and connection to history amidst urban hustle and bustle.

2. **The surprising charm of 'collecting interesting teacups' is becoming a quiet hobby for many.**
   It's all about finding unique designs and patterns, often from charity shops or antique markets, and enjoying a lovely brew in them.

3. **More people are finding quiet enjoyment in the art of 'identifying British garden birds'.**
   Armed with binoculars and a good guide, enthusiasts are spending peaceful hours watching feathered friends from their windows or local parks.

4. **The delightful trend of 'decorating your bookshelf like a miniature art installation' is growing.**
   It involves arranging books by colour, adding small ornaments, and creating pleasing visual displays that make reading corners even more inviting.

5. **A new appreciation for 'vintage board games from the 70s and 80s' is sweeping through homes.**
   Families are rediscovering the joy of classic games, often found in attics or at car boot sales, for a nostalgic evening of fun.

6. **The comforting ritual of 'listening to a favourite radio play' is making a comeback.**
   Many are choosing to switch off screens and immerse themselves in the power of storytelling through sound, often while doing household chores or relaxing.

7. **The simple pleasure of 'finding a perfectly ripe avocado' is being celebrated on social media.**
   After years of avocado roulette, the sheer joy of slicing into a perfectly green, creamy one is proving to be a small but significant moment of daily delight.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: SMELLING IT INTENSELY AND THEN SHOWING IT TO AT LEAST ONE OTHER PERSON FOR THEIR APPROVAL.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of sparkling water will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: SHAKING IT GENTLY AND LISTENING TO THE FIZZ, AS IF THE SOUND HOLDS THE SECRET TO ITS BUBBLINESS.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday item' just instantly makes you feel a bit nostalgic or takes you back to a specific time, even if it's something as simple as a particular brand of biscuit or a type of old-fashioned sweet?**
  What's that one everyday item that always conjures up strong memories for you, and why?

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household task' that, for some reason, we find surprisingly therapeutic or satisfying to do, even if it's something mundane like polishing silver or organising a drawer.**
  What's your surprisingly therapeutic household chore, and what makes it so calming for you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can sometimes be heard, making a faint crackling sound during particularly strong displays.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically 1/100th of a second.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwllllantysiliogogogoch, in Wales.
- The inventor of the refreshing 'Rubik's Cube', Ernő Rubik, originally created it as a teaching tool to help his students understand 3D objects.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The total weight of all the ants on Earth is estimated to be greater than the total weight of all humans.
- It is illegal to sing 'Happy Birthday' in public for commercial purposes without paying royalties, due to its historical copyright.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES MON 19 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 292 of the year, 73 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Coptic Orthodox Church of Alexandria); Christian feast day: Blessed Agnes of Jesus; Christian feast day: Aquilinus of Évreux; Christian feast day: Desiderius (Didier) of Auxerre. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1960 — Dan Woodgate, English musician, songwriter, composer, and record producer
- 1945 — Jeannie C. Riley, American singer
- 1980 — Benjamin Salisbury, American actor
- 1946 — Philip Pullman, English author and academic
- 1957 — Karl Wallinger, Welsh singer-songwriter, keyboard player, and producer (died 2024)
- 1972 — Pras, American rapper-songwriter, record producer, and actor
- 1993 — Hunter King, American actress
- 1963 — Sinitta, American-British singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1950 — Iran becomes the first country to accept technical assistance from the United States under the Point Four Program.
- 1953 — Ray Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451 is published.
- 2004 — Thirteen people are killed when Corporate Airlines Flight 5966 crashes in Adair County, Missouri, while on approach to Kirksville Regional Airport.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1955 — The General Assembly of the European Broadcasting Union approves the staging of the first Eurovision Song Contest.
- 2003 — Mother Teresa is beatified by Pope John Paul II.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1943 — The cargo vessel Sinfra is attacked by Allied aircraft at Crete and sunk. Two thousand and ninety-eight Italian prisoners of war drown with it.
- 1960 — The United States imposes a near-total trade embargo against Cuba.

- 2005 — Hurricane Wilma becomes the most intense Atlantic hurricane on record with a minimum pressure of 882 mb.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES TUE 20 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 293 of the year, 72 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Acca of Hexham; Christian feast days: Aderald; Christian feast days: Artemius; Christian feast days: Caprasius of Agen. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Andrew Trimble, Irish rugby player
- 1977 — Sam Witwer, American actor and musician
- 1938 — Dolores Hart, American actress and nun
- 1997 — Ademola Lookman, Nigerian footballer
- 1958 — Valerie Faris, American director and producer
- 1974 — Limmy, Scottish comedian and writer
- 1988 — ASAP Ferg, American rapper
- 1955 — Thomas Newman, American composer and conductor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1951 — The "Johnny Bright incident" occurs during a football game between the Drake Bulldogs and Oklahoma A&M Aggies.
- 2017 — Syrian civil war: The Syrian Democratic Forces (SDF) declare victory in the Raqqa campaign.
- 1977 — A plane carrying the rock band Lynyrd Skynyrd crashes in woodland in Mississippi, United States. Six people, including three band members, are killed.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2011 — Libyan Crisis: Rebel forces capture Libyan dictator Muammar Gaddafi and his son Mutassim in his hometown of Sirte and kill them shortly thereafter, ending the first Libyan civil war.
- 1961 — The Soviet Navy performs the first armed test of a submarine-launched ballistic missile, launching an R-13 from a Golf-class submarine.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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